

# Stephen Paul Watson

Senior Software Engineer

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## WORK EXPERIENCE

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### Watkyn LLC

Staff Software Engineer

Remote

Nov 2024 - Aug 2025

- Led a cross-functional **Scrum** team to migrate a legacy monolith to **microservices**, achieving zero downtime and enabling independent feature releases that accelerated **time-to-market** by 30%.
- Architected a **cloud-native** system leveraging microservices and event-driven design, improving scalability to handle **5x traffic increase**.
- **Mentored** junior engineers and established knowledge-sharing sessions, reducing dependency on senior staff and boosting feature delivery speed by 25%.
- Collaborated directly with product managers and stakeholders to align technical designs with business objectives.

Senior Software Engineer

Jul 2018 - Oct 2024

- Designed and developed a modular **ERP system** with **React** and **Node.js**, streamlining business operations and improving efficiency for startups to enterprises.
- Defined technical boundaries and **API contracts** for 12+ microservices, minimizing dependencies and slashing bottlenecks by 30%.
- Implemented **event-driven architecture** with **Apache Kafka**, handling 5M+ events daily.
- Built intuitive user interfaces for complex data entry and reporting dashboards using **TypeScript** and **React**, reducing user-reported errors by 25%.
- Developed a dynamic pricing engine and API using **Python**, **FastAPI**, and NumPy, which analyzed market and competitor data to increase profit margins by an average of 6%.
- Developed a **RAG-based** question-answering system for the company wiki using **LangChain**, allowing employees to query internal documentation using natural language.
- Fine-tuned **LLMs** on industry-specific terminology, resulting in a 35% increase in accuracy on a validation test set of domain-specific queries.
- Deployed and managed cloud infrastructure on **AWS** using **Terraform** for IaC, reducing costs by 10% through optimized resource allocation.
- Built **CI/CD pipelines** with **Jenkins**, containerized applications with **Docker**, and orchestrated scalable deployments on **Kubernetes**.

## Arkansas Health Network

Software Engineer

Arkansas

Jun 2014 - Jun 2018

- Designed and developed **telehealth** platform with **Angular** and **Node.js** from concept to launch, supporting over 50K monthly active users.
- Designed and developed a modular UI system with **TypeScript** and **Angular**, improving development velocity and ensuring responsive, cross-platform consistency.
- Built **HIPAA**-compliant **RESTful APIs** and **GraphQL** endpoints to securely handle electronic health records (EHR) across multiple platforms.
- Drove a quality-first culture by implementing a comprehensive **testing** strategy with **Jest** and **Cypress**, achieving 90% code coverage and reducing production bugs by 20%.
- Worked in a **fast-paced** startup environment, contributing to the successful release of shippable products every week through **agile** sprint cycles.

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## SKILLS

- **Languages:** JavaScript, TypeScript, Python
- **Frameworks:** React/Next.js/Angular, Node.js/Nest.js, Flask/FastAPI
- **Databases:** MySQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Redis, Query Tuning
- **Testing:** Jest, Cypress, Test-Driven Development
- **AI:** LangChain, RAG, Large Language Models, Transformers, Prompt Engineering
- **Architecture:** Microservices, Event-Driven, Distributed Systems, API Design, System Security
- **Cloud & DevOps:** AWS, Azure, Docker/Kubernetes, Jenkins, Terraform, Prometheus/Grafana
- **Others:** REST APIs, GraphQL, gRPC, WebSockets, Kafka, Git, Agile & Scrum, OAuth2, API versioning

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## EDUCATION

Arkansas Tech University

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

Aug 2010 - May 2014